2.1.2 Implementation overview

The Natter API is written in Java 11 using the Spark Java (http://sparkjava.com) framework (not to be confused with the Apache Spark data analytics platform). To make the examples as clear as possible to non-Java developers, they are written in a simple style avoiding too many Java-specific idioms. The code is also written for clarity and simplicity rather than production-readiness. Maven is used to build the code examples, and an H2 in-memory database (https://h2database.com) is used for data storage. The Dalesbred database abstraction library (https://dalesbred.org) is used to provide a more convenient interface to the database than Java's JDBC interface, without bringing in the complexity of a full object-relational mapping (ORM) framework.

Detailed instructions on installing these dependencies for Mac, Windows, and Linux are in appendix A. If you don't have all or any of these installed, be sure you have them ready before you continue.

> **TIP** For the best learning experience, it is a good idea to type out the listings in this book by hand, so that you are sure you understand every line. But if you want to get going more quickly, the full source code of each chapter is available on GitHub from https://github.com/NeilMadden/apisecurityinaction. Follow the instructions in the README.md file to get set up.